Skyscrapers

High-rise buildings dominate the skylines of many cities, because they offer large accommodation space but occupy a small area of land. As construction technology has improved, ever-taller skyscrapers have been built, and buildings with more than 160 floors are now feasible.

Skyscraper structures

Buildings made of brick or stone require thick, heavy walls, which makes it impractical to have more than five or six floors. Skyscrapers can be built much higher because they have lightweight steel frames and walls. However, they must be able to resist high-altitude winds that would make them sway and must also have elevators to move people efficiently up and down the building (see pp.100–101).

